

SYNTEN INC

Operational Knowledge Lifecycle and Approval Policy

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Version / type	1.0.0 / POLICY
Status	APPROVED
Owner	Knowledge Governance
Effective	2026-08-30T09:00:00Z
Incident family	AUTHORIZATION_DECLINE_RATE_SPIKE
Classification	Internal - Synthetic Demo

Synthetic demonstration data only. No real payments, customers, merchants, credentials, or company records.

Document control

Control	Value
Owner	Knowledge Governance
Audience	Payment Operations, Incident Management, technical owners, and reviewers
Review cadence	Every 180 days and after a material control or corpus change
Related documents	PL-002, corpus/inventory.md
Retrieval role	Defines approval, effective version, supersession, review, and source provenance.
Classification	Internal - Synthetic Demo

Revision history

Version	Status	Date	Summary
1.0.0	APPROVED	2026-08-30	Controlled corpus version for authorization-decline governance.

1. Purpose

This policy establishes mandatory SynTen Inc controls for runbook/policy ownership, versions, and retrieval eligibility. It supports auditable investigation of the synthetic authorization-decline incident family while preserving evidence integrity and human authority.

2. Scope

The policy applies to synthetic alerts, evidence attempts, approved knowledge, retrieval context, AI-assisted reports, human decisions, escalation records, and audit projections associated with the tenant ID shown on the cover.

It does not authorize real payment processing, access to real customer or merchant data, production remediation, external communication, or model approval of an operational decision.

3. Governing principles

- Observed facts, inference, approved guidance, recommendation, and human decision must remain distinguishable.
- Tenant, source, version, time, status, model, retrieval, and decision metadata must remain reviewable.
- Missing or contradictory information must reduce confidence rather than invite fabrication.
- No recommendation executes automatically; human authority remains outside the model boundary.

4. Mandatory controls

1. Only APPROVED, effective, tenant-matching, incident-family-matching versions may enter lexical or vector ranking.
2. A source, metadata, extraction, or embedding-input change creates a new version and requires new hashes and embeddings.
3. SUPERSEDED material must remain auditable but must be excluded before ranking, even on an exact lexical match.
4. Every document must have an owner, review cadence, revision history, source hash, and approved replacement where applicable.

5. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted or informed
Knowledge Governance	Maintain this policy and control evidence.	Approve content through the synthetic role account.	Incident Management and affected technical owners.
Payment Operations Analyst	Apply the policy during investigation and record limitations.	Accountable for the submitted human review decision.	Incident Commander and evidence owners.
Technical owner	Confirm component-specific facts and authorize separate actions.	Accountable for changes within that owner's controlled system.	Payment Operations and security where applicable.
Knowledge Approver	Verify version, status, classification, and retrieval eligibility.	Accountable for approved/effective publication.	Document owner and Operational Assurance.

6. Evidence and records

Retain the authoritative incident, evidence attempt, retrieval attempt, selected chunk references, report attempt, model and prompt metadata, human decision, and chronological audit projection. Do not replace a failed or superseded record with a cleaner narrative.

Control evidence must use opaque synthetic identifiers and UTC timestamps. Raw credentials, private endpoints, plausible personal or payment data, and unbounded provider payloads are prohibited.

7. Exceptions and non-compliance

There is no exception allowing a model to approve a report, execute a recommendation, use cross-tenant data, or conceal missing evidence. A human may document an operational exception outside the copilot only through the separately governed process and must preserve its owner, rationale, scope, and expiry.

A detected policy breach must be recorded as a limitation, escalated to the owner, and excluded from trusted report support until corrected. Do not silently relabel an ineligible document or malformed source as approved evidence.

8. Monitoring and review

Review retrieval eligibility, source/version hashes, unexplained ranking changes, missing citations, rejected reports, evidence gaps, and attempted automatic actions. Material findings require policy review and a new version rather than an in-place rewrite.

9. Related documents

Apply this policy with PL-002, corpus/inventory.md. Where guidance conflicts, use only the approved and effective version and preserve the conflict for audit.